

PARAKH (NAS) PRACTICE - SOCIAL STUDIES

Picture-Based Questions: Early Human Society & Early Civilisation

Competency: Analyses the effect of various changes in early human society - from nomadism to settled life and early civilisation (agriculture, food habits, technologies, habitation, work and socio-cultural beliefs). This booklet has PICTURE-BASED questions only.

Suitable for Classes 6 to 9 (NCERT 'Our Pasts' / SCERT Telangana Social Studies)

General Instructions

1. This booklet has 24 picture-based multiple-choice questions (8 per picture).
2. Each question has four options - A, B, C and D. Only ONE is correct.
3. Study each picture (and its caption) carefully before answering.
4. The Answer Key with brief explanations is given at the end.
5. There is no negative marking in NAS.

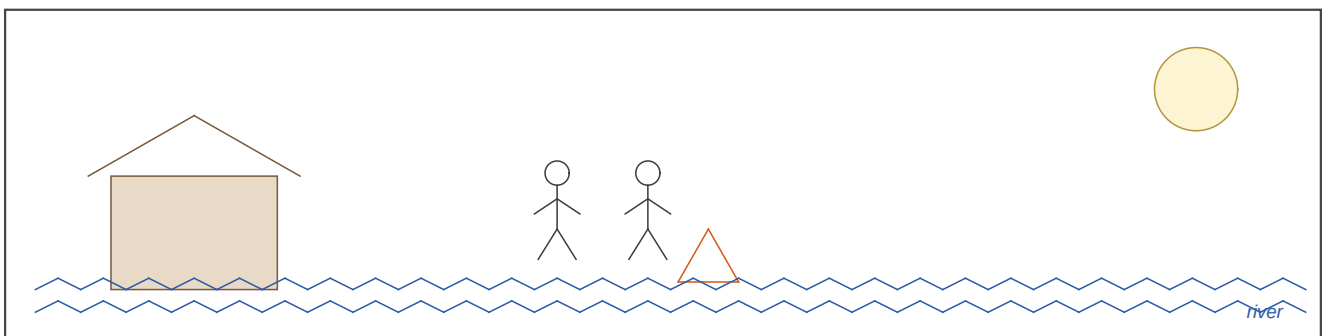
About the pictures & sources (read before verifying):

Each picture is shown as a captioned box with a simple schematic and a short description; if you have the textbook you may paste the original picture into the box. Every question carries a 'Reference from:' line (book -> class -> chapter -> concept). Page numbers are omitted (they vary by edition). Items marked [!] should be verified in a Class 9/higher text before use.

PICTURE 1 - EARLY HUMAN LIFE NEAR A RIVER

Study the picture and answer Questions 1 to 8.

Picture 1: A scene of early human life beside a river (textbook illustration)



What the picture shows: Early people beside a river - some are catching fish, some are gathering food, some are cooking over a fire, and simple huts / shelters and clay pots can be seen.

(If you have the textbook, you may paste the original picture inside the box above.)

1. What does the picture mainly show?
 - A. People living in a modern city
 - B. Early people living and working near a river / water body
 - C. A factory full of machines
 - D. Astronauts working in space

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2 'On the Trail of the Earliest People' & Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS - early humans. Concept: early people lived near water.

2. Why did early people prefer to live near rivers and other water bodies?
 - A. To watch television
 - B. For drinking water, fish and other food, and fertile land
 - C. To build railway stations
 - D. To stay away from all food

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food' (why people settled near rivers); SCERT

Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: importance of rivers/water.

3. Some people in the picture are catching fish. This shows that fishing was a way of getting:

- A. Clothes**
- B. Food**
- C. Iron tools**
- D. Money**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2 (hunting animals, catching fish and birds); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: fishing as a source of food.

4. The pots seen in the picture were mainly used to:

- A. Fly across the river**
- B. Store and cook food and water**
- C. Write letters**
- D. Make iron**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 & Ch.4 (pottery for storing grain and cooking); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: use of pottery.

5. People are cooking food over a fire. Learning to use fire changed early people's:

- A. Food habits - they began to cook their food**
- B. School timings**
- C. Language only**
- D. Clothing fashion only**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2 (discovery/use of fire, cooking); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: fire changed food habits.

6. Living and working together in a group, as shown, points to the beginning of:

- A. Lonely wandering for ever**
- B. Community / group life**
- C. Big factories**
- D. Sea trade with other countries**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2 & Ch.3 (living and working in groups); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: beginnings of community life.

7. Which activity would you NOT expect to see in this early river-side scene?

- A. Catching fish**
- B. Cooking over a fire**
- C. Using a mobile phone**
- D. Gathering fruits**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.2 (life of the earliest people); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: distinguishing early life from modern life.

8. This way of life near rivers slowly led early people towards:

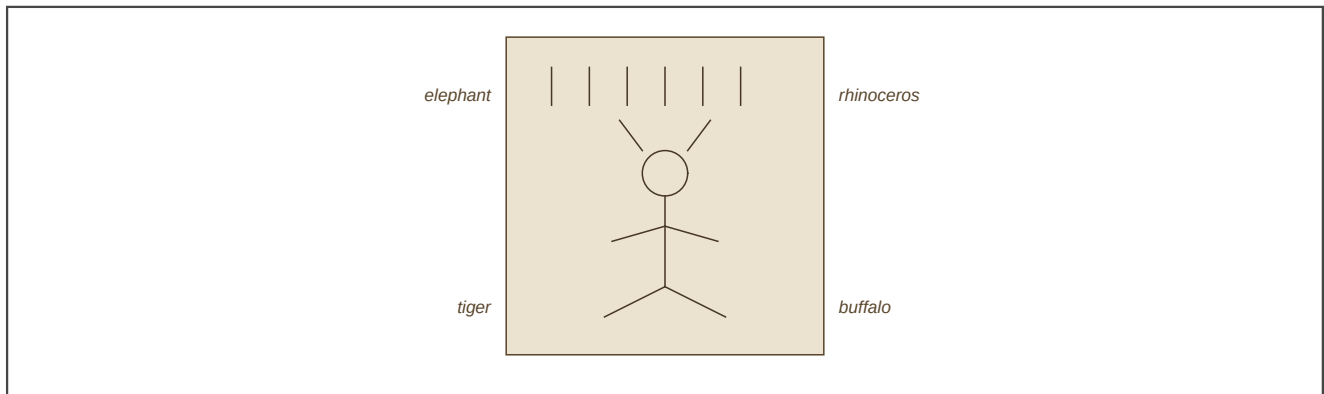
- A. Giving up all food**
- B. Settled village life and farming**
- C. Building aeroplanes**
- D. Deep-sea diving**

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.3 'From Gathering to Growing Food'; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: river-side life led to settled farming.

PICTURE 2 - FIGURE OF A MALE GOD FROM HARAPPA (A SEAL)

Study the picture and answer Questions 9 to 16.

Picture 2: 'Figure of a male god from Harappa' - a Harappan seal



What the picture shows: A small carved stone seal from the Harappan civilisation. It shows a seated male figure wearing a horned head-dress, surrounded by animals (elephant, rhinoceros, tiger and buffalo), with short signs of the Harappan script along the top.

(If you have the textbook, you may paste the original picture inside the box above.)

9. The object shown in the picture is a ____ from the Harappan civilisation.

- A. Coin
- B. Seal
- C. Paper painting
- D. Photograph

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities' (Harappan seals); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS (Harappan civilisation, Fig 17.x - 'figure of a male god from Harappa'). Concept: identifying a seal.

10. The picture shows a male figure surrounded by:

- A. Cars
- B. Animals
- C. Tall buildings
- D. Ships

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (seals showing figures & animals); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: what the seal shows.

11. Harappan seals like this were mainly used for:

- A. Cooking food
- B. Trade - to stamp or mark goods
- C. Ploughing fields
- D. Catching fish

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (seals) & Ch.10 (trade); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: seals used to mark goods for trade. [!] 'stamping for trade' - confirm wording in your edition.

12. The short signs seen on many Harappan seals are part of the Harappan script, which today is:

- A. Fully read and understood
- B. Not yet deciphered (cannot be read)
- C. Written in English
- D. Written in Telugu

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (Harappan writing on seals cannot yet be read); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: undeciphered Harappan script.

13. A seal like this (a 'male god') mainly tells us about the Harappan people's:

- A. Sports
- B. Beliefs (religion)
- C. School system
- D. Railway lines

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS (caption: 'a male god'). Concept: seals tell us about beliefs/religion.

14. Harappan seals were usually made of:

- A. Plastic
- B. Stone (steatite)
- C. Iron
- D. Paper

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (seals made of steatite stone); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: material of seals.

15. The animals shown around the figure (such as elephant, tiger and rhinoceros) suggest that the Harappans:

- A. Had never seen any animals
- B. Knew the wild animals of their land
- C. Kept only sea animals
- D. Used only machines

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.4 (animals on seals); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: Harappans knew wild animals of their land.

16. For a historian or an archaeologist, such a seal is an example of a:

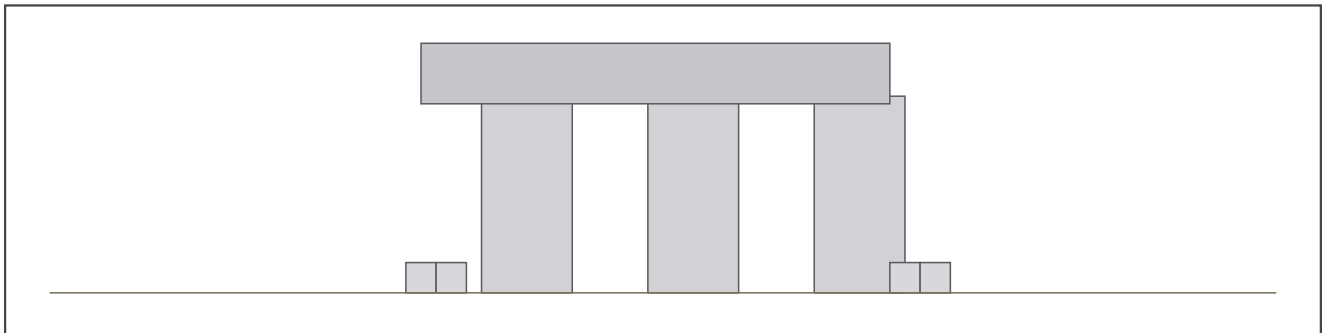
- A. Primary (archaeological) source
- B. Modern newspaper
- C. School textbook
- D. Story book

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.1 'What, Where, How and When?' & Ch.4; SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS. Concept: seals as primary/archaeological source. (Cf. NAS 2024 Grade 9 Q19.)

PICTURE 3 - DOLMEN (MEGALITHIC BURIAL), POTHANAPALLI, MAHABUBNAGAR

Study the picture and answer Questions 17 to 24.

Picture 3: Dolmen type of Megalithic Burial, Pothanapalli, Mahabubnagar



What the picture shows: A dolmen - a burial made of large upright stone slabs with a big flat capstone resting on top, found at Pothanapalli in Mahabubnagar (Telangana).

(If you have the textbook, you may paste the original picture inside the box above.)

17. The structure shown in the picture is a:

- A. Modern house
- B. Megalithic (big-stone) burial
- C. Temple tower
- D. Railway bridge

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5 'What Bones and Burials Tell Us' (megaliths/dolmens); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS (megalithic burial, Pothanapalli, Mahabubnagar). Concept: identifying a megalith.

18. The word 'megalith' means:

- A. Big stone
- B. Small pot
- C. Iron tool
- D. Flowing river

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5 ('megalith' = big stone); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: meaning of 'megalith'.

19. Structures like this were built mainly to:

- A. Store grain
- B. Bury the dead and mark their graves
- C. Keep cattle
- D. Cross rivers

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5 (stones placed over/around graves); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: purpose of megaliths.

20. Megaliths like this one tell us about early people's beliefs about:

- A. Farming tools
- B. Death and the dead
- C. Sea trade
- D. City drainage

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5 (burials & beliefs about death); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: megaliths and beliefs about death.

21. This dolmen is made of:

- A. Bricks and cement
- B. Large stone slabs
- C. Iron sheets
- D. Wood and glass

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5 (large stones/slabs); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: a dolmen is made of large stone slabs.

22. Along with the dead body, people often placed ____ in such burials.

- A. Mobile phones
- B. Pots, tools and beads (grave goods)
- C. Plastic toys
- D. Electric lamps

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Past-I', Ch.5 (grave goods - pots, iron tools, beads placed with the dead); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. Concept: grave goods.

23. Megalithic burials like the one at Pothanapalli, Mahabubnagar, are found in:

- A.** Only North India
- B.** Telangana and other parts of South India
- C.** Only foreign countries
- D.** Only deserts

Reference from: SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS (megaliths in Telangana - Pothanapalli, Mahabubnagar); NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.5 (megaliths in South India / the Deccan). Concept: where megaliths are found.

24. Megaliths are generally linked with the ____ Age, when people had begun using iron.

- A.** Old Stone
- B.** Iron
- C.** Modern (computer)
- D.** Middle Stone

Reference from: NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.5 (iron tools found in megalithic burials, about 3000 years ago); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS. [!] 'Iron Age' label - verify in Class 9/higher text. Concept: megaliths & the Iron Age.

ANSWER KEY WITH EXPLANATIONS

PICTURE 1 - EARLY HUMAN LIFE NEAR A RIVER

1. (B) The scene shows early humans by a river - gathering, fishing and cooking.
2. (B) Rivers gave water to drink, fish and plants to eat, and fertile land - so people settled near them.
3. (B) Early people hunted animals and caught fish and birds for food.
4. (B) Pots (pottery) were used to store grain and water and to cook food.
5. (A) Fire let people cook food, roast meat and keep warm - a change in food habits and daily life.
6. (B) Doing tasks together shows early community life, which later grew into villages.
7. (C) Mobile phones are modern; early people fished, cooked on fire and gathered food.
8. (B) Staying near water and food sources gradually led to settled villages and farming.

PICTURE 2 - FIGURE OF A MALE GOD FROM HARAPPA (A SEAL)

9. (B) It is a Harappan seal, usually a small carved piece of stone.
10. (B) The seal shows a seated male figure with animals around it.
11. (B) Seals were pressed on wet clay to mark bundles of goods, mainly for trade.
12. (B) The Harappan script has not yet been deciphered, so we cannot read it.
13. (B) A figure worshipped as a god tells us about the people's beliefs / religion.
14. (B) Most Harappan seals were made of a stone called steatite.
15. (B) Showing real wild animals means the Harappans knew the animals living around them.
16. (A) A seal made and used by the Harappans is a primary (archaeological) source.

PICTURE 3 - DOLMEN (MEGALITHIC BURIAL), POTHANAPALLI, MAHABUBNAGAR

17. (B) It is a dolmen - a burial made of large stones (a megalith).
18. (A) 'Megalith' comes from mega (big) + lith (stone) = big stone.
19. (B) Megaliths were used to bury the dead and to mark the burial place with big stones.
20. (B) The way the dead were buried tells us about people's beliefs about death.
21. (B) A dolmen is made of large upright stone slabs with a big capstone on top.
22. (B) Grave goods such as pots, iron tools and beads were placed with the dead.
23. (B) Many megaliths are found in Telangana and across South India (the Deccan).
24. (B) Megaliths belong to the period when iron came into use - the Iron Age.

SOURCE & VERIFICATION SUMMARY

Book, class, chapter and concept below are dependable pointers to where each picture and idea is taught. Page numbers are omitted on purpose (they change between editions); share the textbook PDF and verified page numbers can be added.

Picture 1 - Early life near a river

NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.2 (earliest people; fire, food) & Ch.3 (settling near rivers; farming); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS - early humans. [High - core text]

Picture 2 - 'Male god from Harappa' (seal)

NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.4 'In the Earliest Cities' (seals of steatite, animals, undeciphered script) & Ch.1 (sources); SCERT Telangana Class 6 SS (Harappan civilisation). [High - core text]

Picture 3 - Dolmen / megalithic burial

NCERT Class 6 'Our Pasts-I', Ch.5 'What Bones and Burials Tell Us' (megaliths, grave goods, beliefs about death); SCERT Telangana Class 6/7 SS (megaliths in Telangana - Pothanapalli, Mahabubnagar). [High - core text]

[!] Stretch items to verify

The 'Iron Age' label (Q24) and the exact wording that seals were used 'to stamp goods for trade' (Q11) are treated more fully in Class 9/higher texts - verify before use.

Honesty note for the reviewer: the schematics are only place-holders for the real textbook pictures; please paste the original images and check every [!]-flagged item before using this with students.